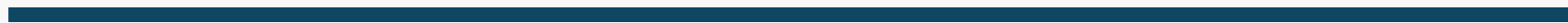




The Effect of Agreeableness on Stereotypes of Native Speakers: Language Proficiency as a Mediating Factor

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Introduction/Literature Review

Language proficiency

- Associated with the understanding of the social norms embedded within that linguistic community (Kramsch, 1998).

Agreeableness

- A dimension of the Big-5 personality scale, associated with empathy, cooperation, and interpersonal warmth (Graziano & Tobin, 2009).
- It is negatively associated with the acceptance of stereotypes and prejudice (Carter et al., 2006; Sibley & Duckitt, 2008).



Introduction/Literature Review

Extraversion

- A dimension of the Big-5 personality scale, associated with positive emotions, assertive behavior, and a desire for social engagement (Joshua & Revelle, 2015).
- Individuals from English-speaking cultures such as the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom often score higher in extraversion compared to other countries (McCrae & Terracciano, 2005).
- In this study, we operationalize perceived extraversion levels of native English speakers as an indicator of stereotypical perception.



Research Questions

- How does agreeableness affect the stereotypical perception of native English speakers' extraversion?
- Does English proficiency moderate this relationship?



Hypothesis

- H1: Lower levels of agreeableness will be associated with stronger stereotypical perceptions of native English speakers' extraversion.
- H2: English language proficiency will moderate this relationship, such that higher proficiency will weaken the association between agreeableness and stereotypical perceptions.



Methodology

We surveyed 123 native Chinese college students (mean age = 20.38, SD = 1.70; 87 women, 34 men, 2 identifying as other) to assess their English proficiency and Big Five personality traits, as well as their perceptions of typical English speakers' Big Five personality traits.

Dependent Variables:

- **Stereotypical perceptions of English speakers' extraversion**
 - Big Five Inventory-2 (BFI-2) - Extraversion
 - [Soto & John, 2016]
 - e.g., A typical English speaker is someone who is outgoing, sociable.
-

Independent Variables:

- **English proficiency**
 - LexTALE
 - [Lemhöfer & Broersma, 2012]
 - e.g., Determine whether this is an existing English word: abergy
- **Self-agreeableness**
 - Big Five Inventory-2 (BFI-2) - Agreeableness
 - [Soto & John, 2016]
 - e.g, I am someone who is compassionate, has a soft heart.

Results

Table 1 Means, standard deviation and Pearson correlation matrix of study variables (n = 123)

	M	SD	1	2	3	4	5	6
1. SP	3.78	0.53	-					
2. Self-Extraversion	2.91	0.55	-0.10	-				
3. Self-Agreeableness	3.59	0.55	0.37**	0.20**	-			
4. Self-Conscientiousness	3.13	0.62	-0.09	0.31**	0.35**	-		
5. Self-Neuroticism	2.88	0.61	0.07	-0.42**	-0.21*	-0.34**	-	
6. Self-Openness	3.48	0.61	-0.10	0.26*	0.44**	0.33**	-0.01	-

SP: stereotypical perception of native English speakers' extraversion.

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

*. Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

- Self-reported agreeableness was significantly correlated with stereotypical perceptions of native English speakers' extraversion ($r = .37$, $p < .001$).
- Unexpectedly, the correlation was positive, contradicting both prior research and our H1, which anticipated a negative association.



Results - Linear Regression

Regression Statistics

<i>Model</i>	<i>R</i>	<i>R Square</i>	<i>Adjusted R Square</i>	<i>Std. Error of the Estimate</i>
1	0.471	0.222	0.204	0.473
2	0.524	0.275	0.250	0.459

ANOVA

<i>Model</i>		<i>Sum of Squares</i>	<i>df</i>	<i>Mean Square</i>	<i>F</i>	<i>Sig.</i>
1	Regression	5.602	2	2.801	12.530	.000
	Residual	19.671	120	0.224		
	Total	25.273	122			
2	Regression	6.942	3	2.314	10.982	.000
	Residual	18.331	119	0.211		
	Total	25.273	122			

Coefficients

	<i>Model</i>	Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	<i>t</i>	<i>Sig.</i>	95.0% Confidence Interval for B	
		<i>B</i>	<i>SE</i>	β			<i>Lower Bound</i>	<i>Upper Bound</i>
1	(Constant)	3.775	0.050		76.174	0.000	3.677	3.874
	Agreeableness	0.468	0.095	0.466	4.952	0.000	0.280	0.656
	EN Proficiency	0.210	0.272	0.073	0.773	0.442	-0.330	0.751
2	(Constant)	3.774	0.048		78.439	0.000	3.679	3.870
	Agreeableness	0.476	0.092	0.473	5.177	0.000	0.293	0.658
	EN Proficiency	0.117	0.267	0.040	0.438	0.663	-0.413	0.647
	Interaction Effect	-1.129	0.448	-0.233	-2.522	0.013	-2.019	-0.239

Interaction Effect: Agreeableness * English Proficiency

- Dependent Variable: Stereotypical perceptions of native English speakers' extraversion
- Model 1
 - Predictors: Self-agreeableness ($\beta = .47$, $p < .001$) + English proficiency (not statistically significant)
 - The model was statistically significant ($p < .001$, $r\text{-square} = .222$)

Results - Linear Regression

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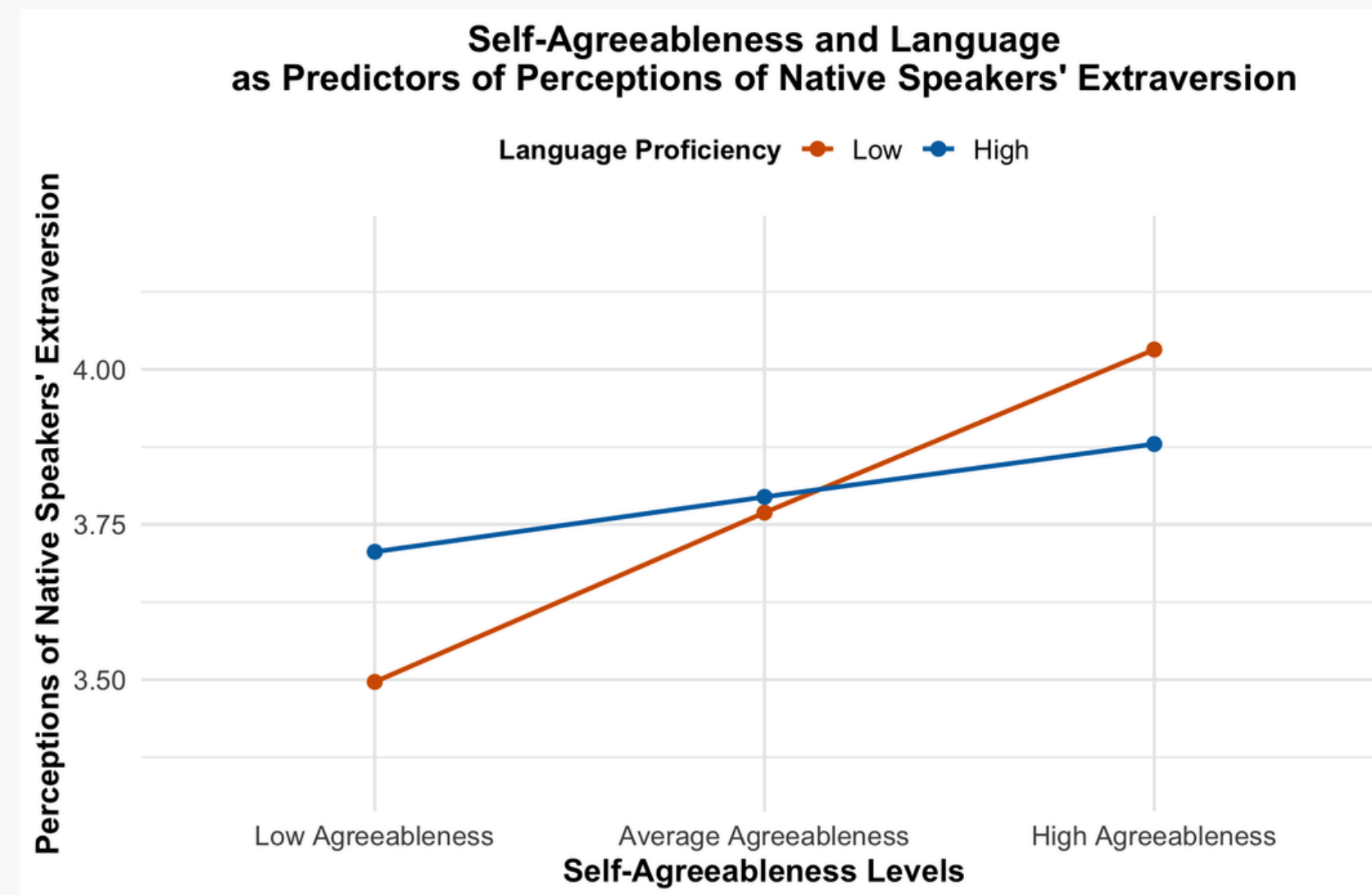
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	Interaction Effect	-1.129	0.448	-0.233	-2.522	0.013	-2.019	-0.239

Interaction Effect: Agreeableness * English Proficiency

- Dependent Variable: Stereotypical perceptions of native English speakers' extraversion
- Model 2
 - Predictors: Self-agreeableness ($\beta = .47$, $p < .001$) + English proficiency (not statistically significant) + Interaction of agreeableness & English proficiency ($\beta = -.23$, $p < .05$)
 - The model was statistically significant ($p < .001$, r-square = .275)

Results - Interaction Effect



Interaction effect is observed. English proficiency buffers the influence of personality on stereotype-based judgments.



Results

H2 is supported.

English proficiency would moderate the relationship between agreeableness and stereotypical perceptions, such that higher proficiency would weaken the effect.



Discussion

Significance

- More agreeable participants were more likely to endorse the stereotype that native English speakers are highly extroverted.
 - The influence of agreeableness on stereotyping may depend on whether the stereotype itself is positive or negative.
- Language proficiency moderated this relationship between agreeableness and stereotype perceptions.
 - Language learning doesn't just enhance communication skills, it also promotes more individualized and less stereotyped perceptions of others.

Discussion

Limitations

- Perceived extraversion may not fully capture stereotypical thinking.
- Generalizability:
 - Limited to Chinese international college students.
 - Focused only on English native speakers.

Reference



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